

Progettazione di Applicazioni Mobili

Mobile design patterns

Onboarding

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Onboarding

- Onboarding is a human resources term that was borrowed by UX designers, and is defined as a way of making someone familiar with an app
- The first contact with an app is crucial to determine whether the user will keep using the app or not
- Dropping users in the middle of the app without any kind of help might result in frustration and abandonment

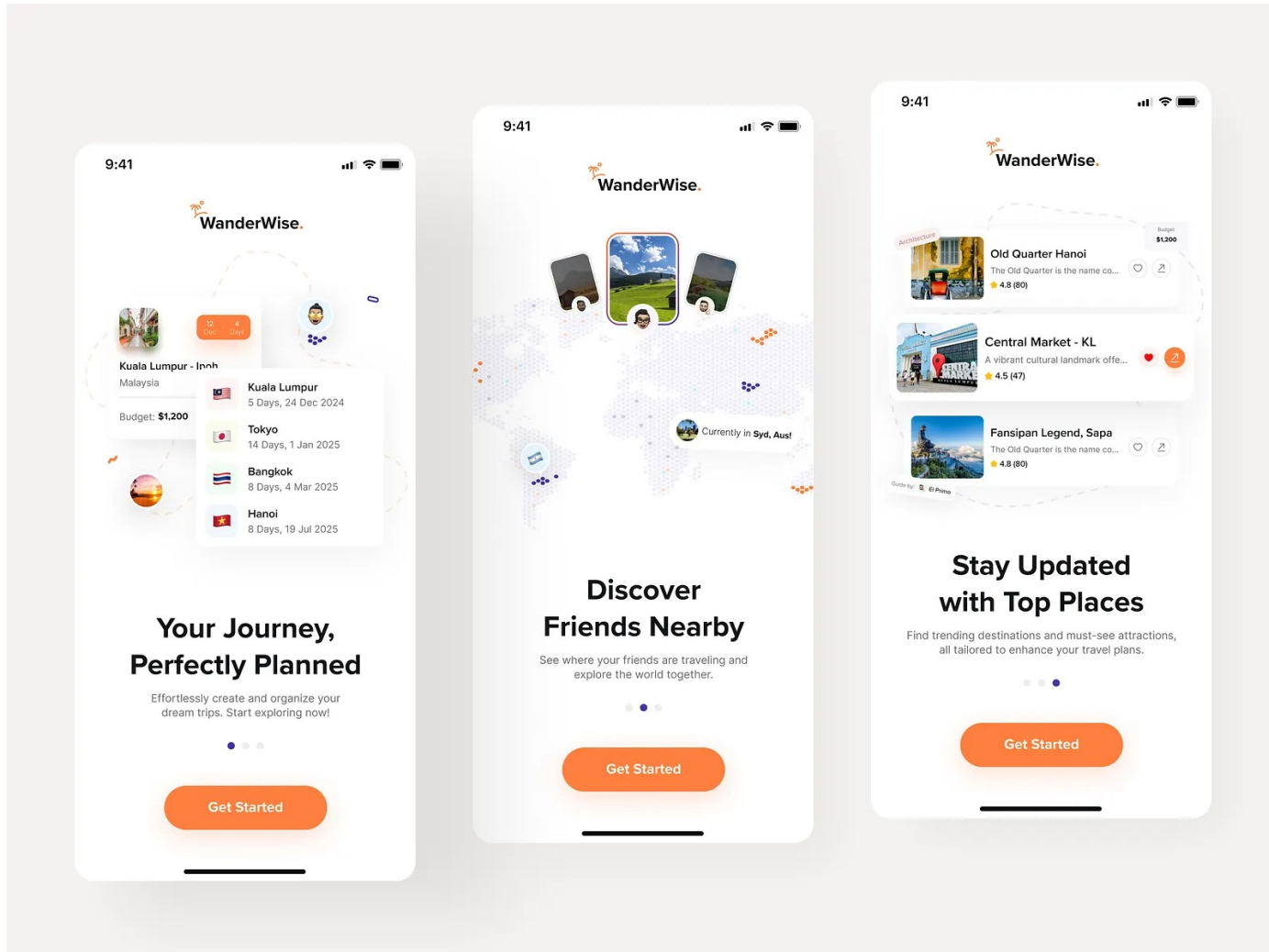
- If your app is simple or self-explanatory, it may not need specific onboarding solutions
- You need an onboarding strategy if your app:
 - Contains non-standard interactions or brand new concepts that might be unfamiliar to users (e.g. an app which uses custom gestures as a primary method of interaction)
 - Has a fairly complex workflow or handles complex tasks (e.g. a complex business app, which has a variety of user roles, each with specific access rights and restrictions)
 - Requires users to populate it with data because its default state is empty
 - Has undergone a major redesign and you want to introduce existing users to new features and changes

- If you require onboarding, two possible solutions to create a positive “first-time through” experience are:
 - Tutorials
 - Invitations
- When tutorials or invitations are designed inappropriately, they cause significant aggravation to new users who are trying to get into the app



Tutorials

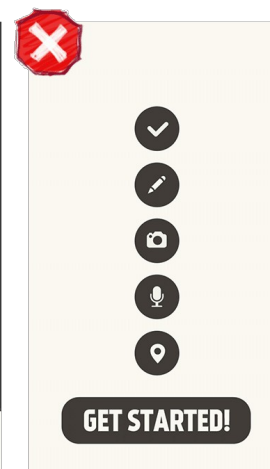
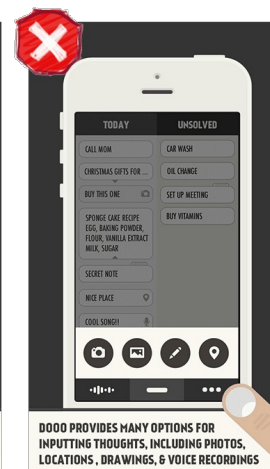
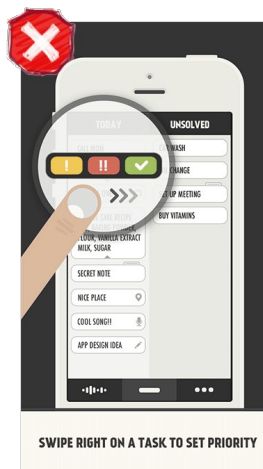
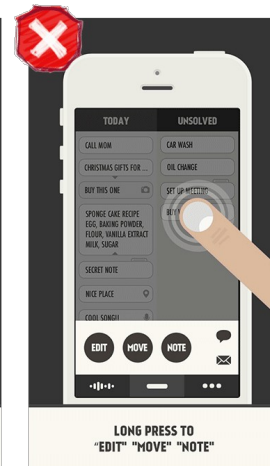
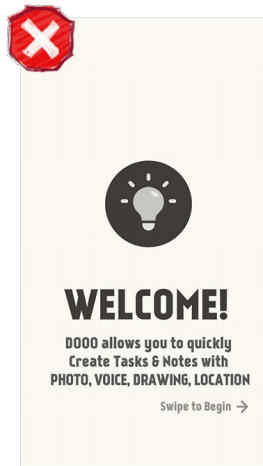
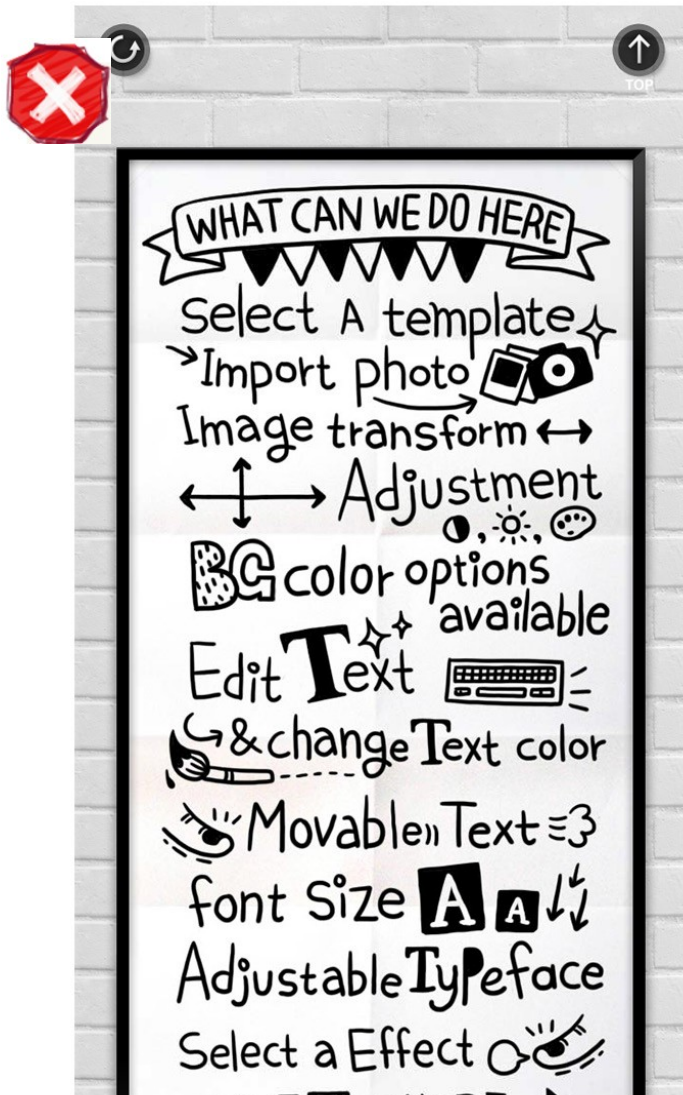
- Two types of tutorial can be found in mobile apps:
 - Tutorials that introduce what an app does, also known as value proposition tours
 - Tutorials that educate users on how to interact with the app by explaining the key actions
- Value proposition tours are the most common but do not provide much help on how to effectively use an app

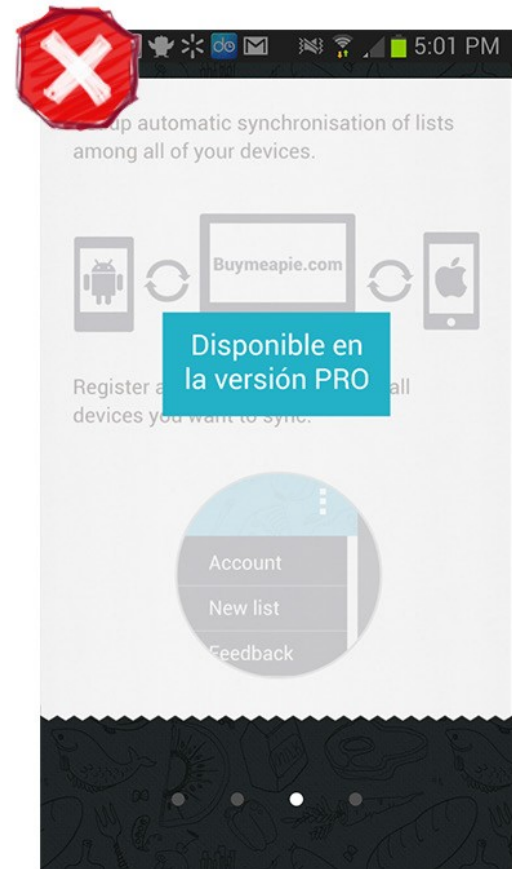
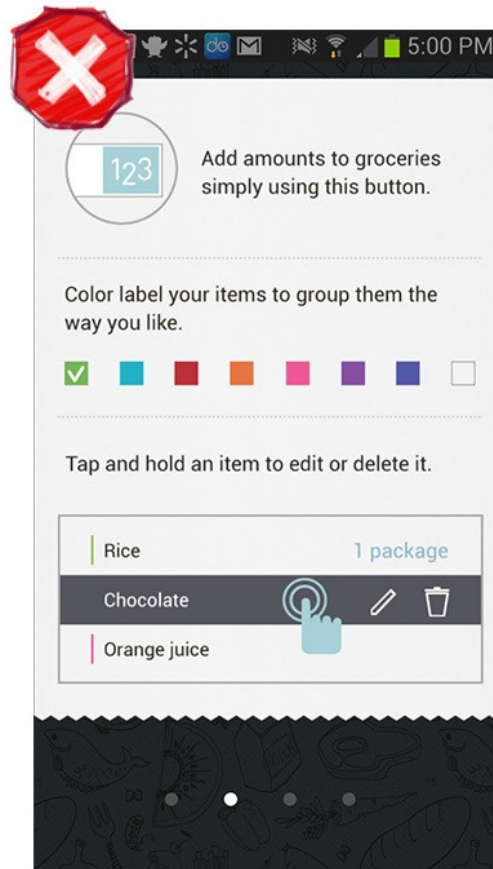
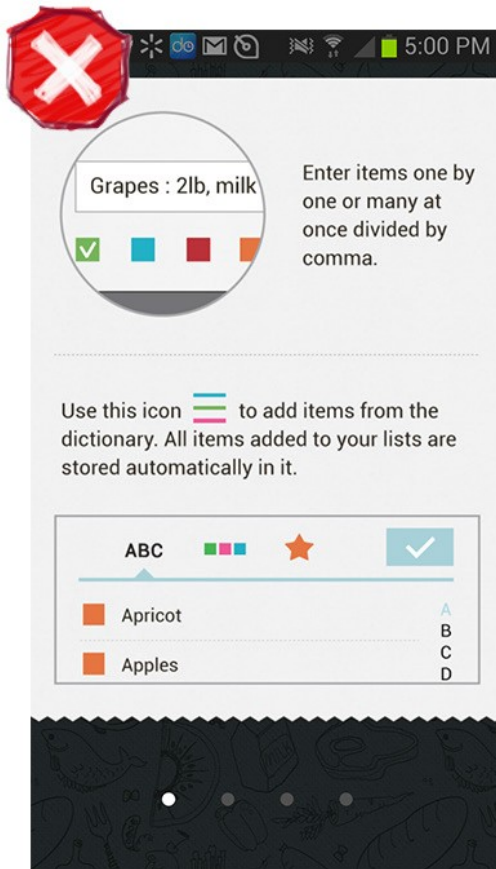


Value proposition tour: static screens that focus on benefits instead of features

No frontloading

- If you frontload your tutorial, teaching everything at the beginning:
 - You're literally blocking users from doing exactly what you want them to do, using your product
 - You're increasing cognitive load
- Rather than overwhelming users with information that they will probably forget by the time they need it, provide the information in short, easily digestible chunks when and where it is needed
- By limiting up-front tutorials to just the “getting started” essentials, you allow your users to dive right in and start using your app

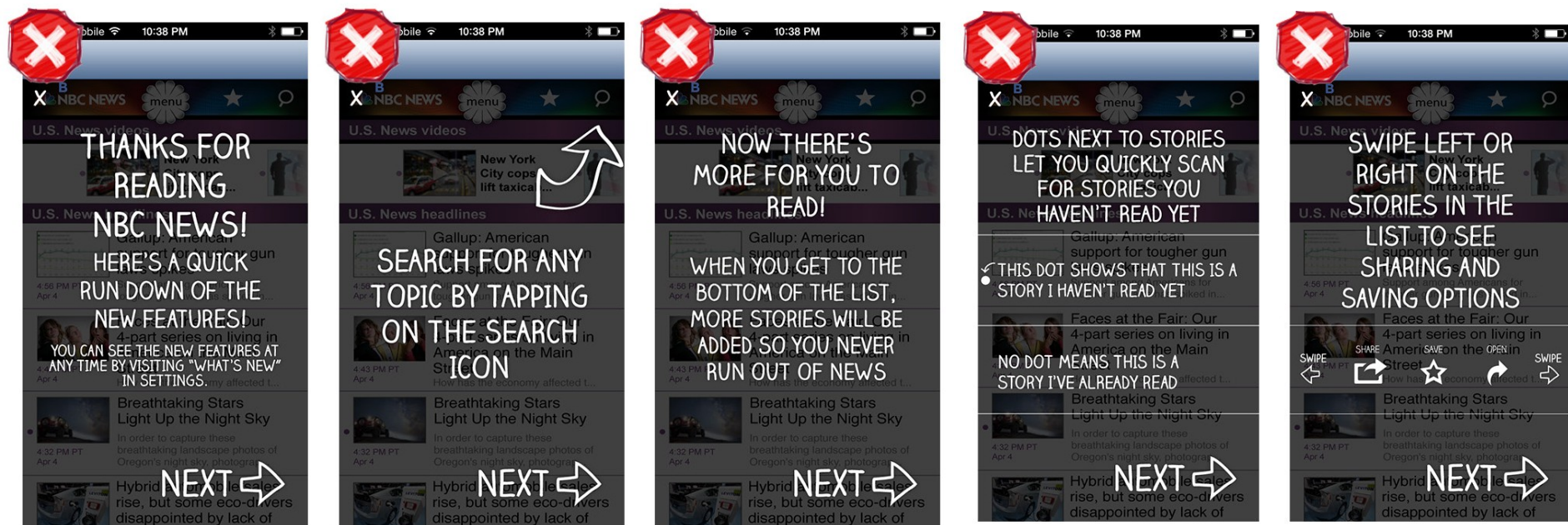




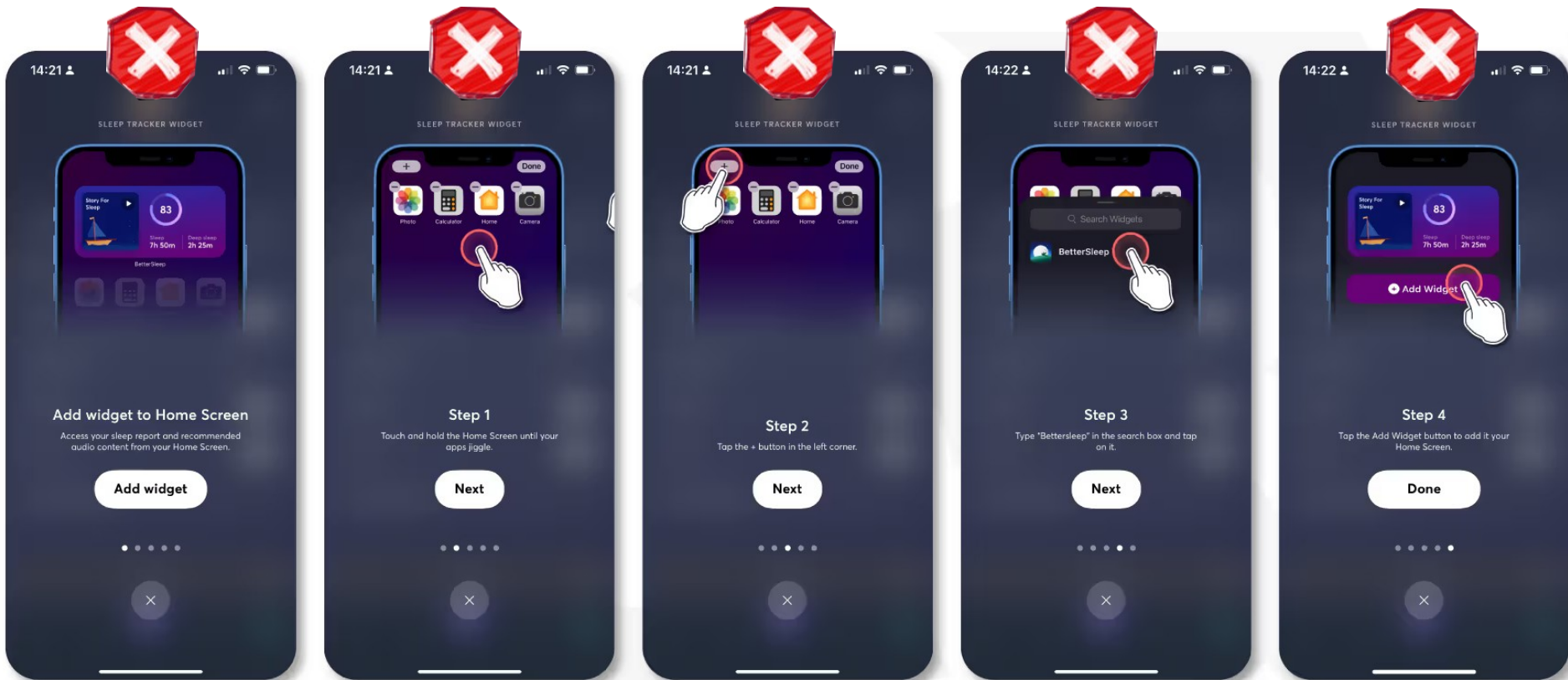
frontloaded, confusing, and out-of-context tour

Let users learn by doing

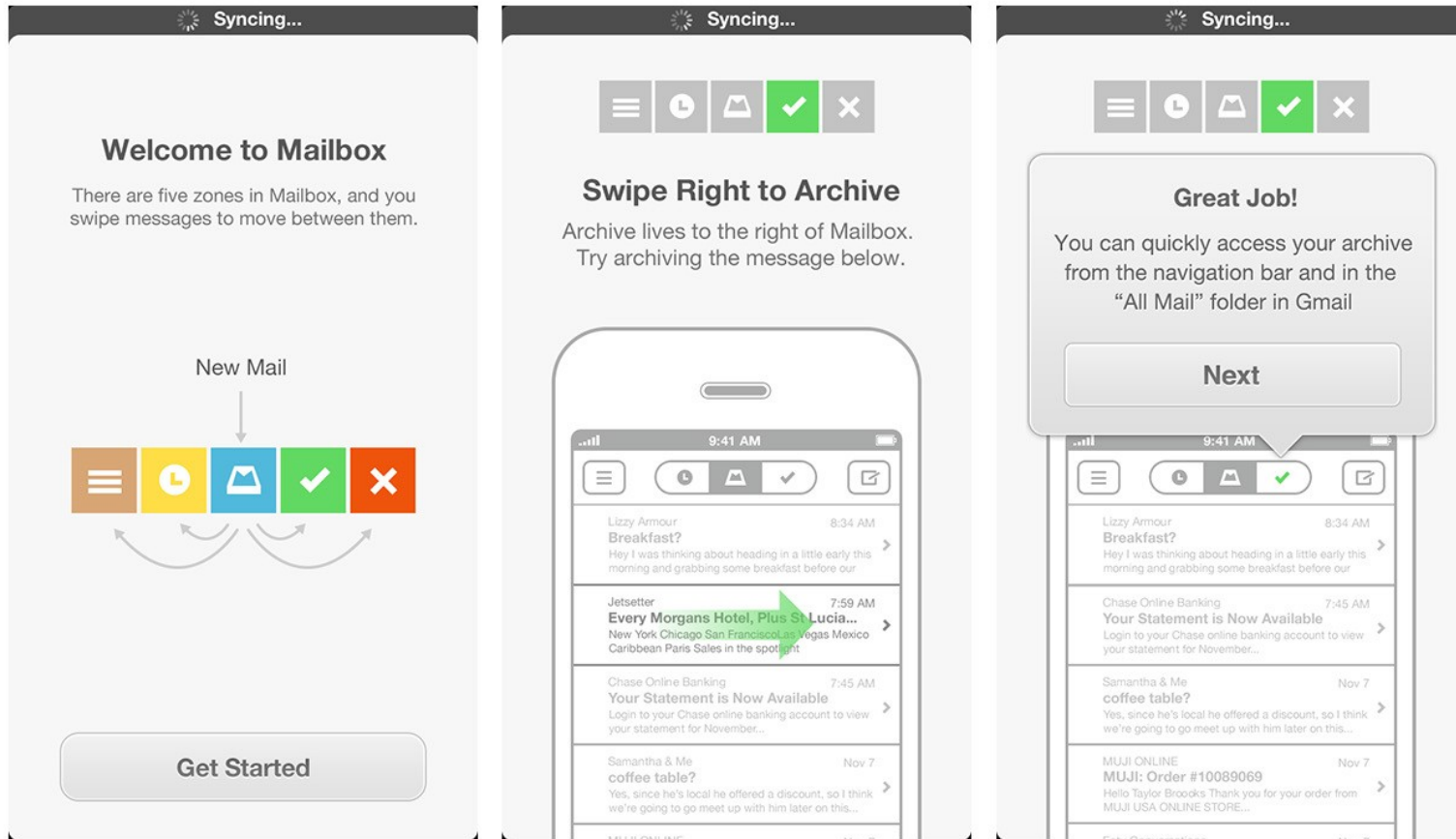
- Tutorials should be interactive, so users learn by doing
- We should avoid relying only on static screens because they kill pacing, destroy immersion, and will often be skipped by the users who need the tutorial the most
- Use text to prompt the “cause” and let the user observe the “effect” by doing



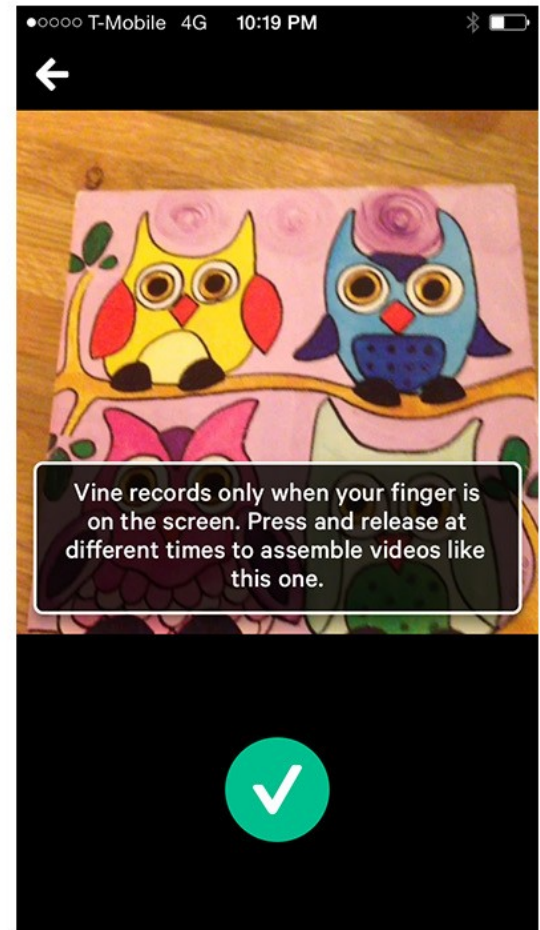
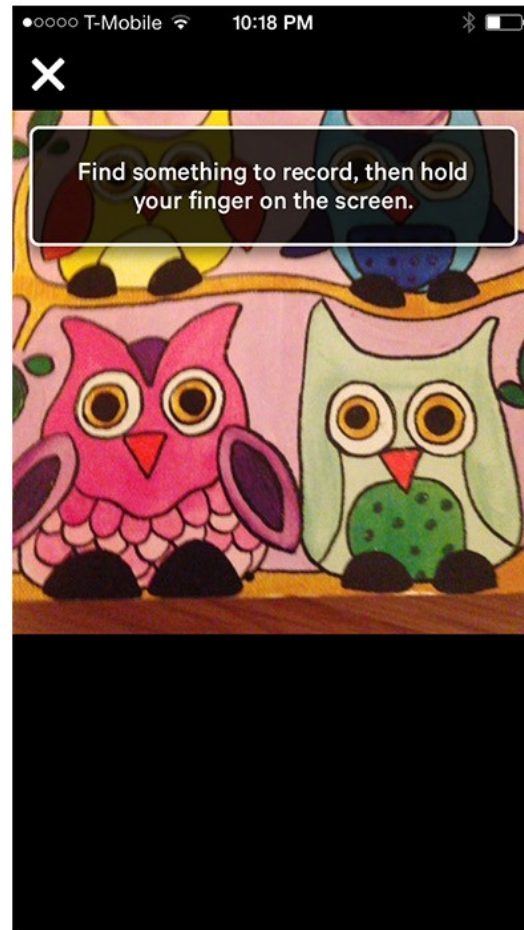
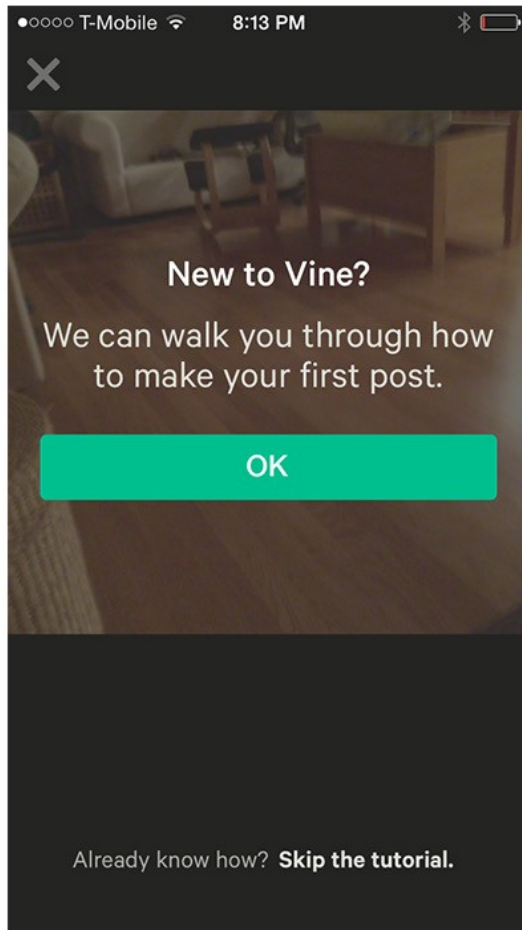
This textual tutorial describes features and actions, but doesn't let the user try them



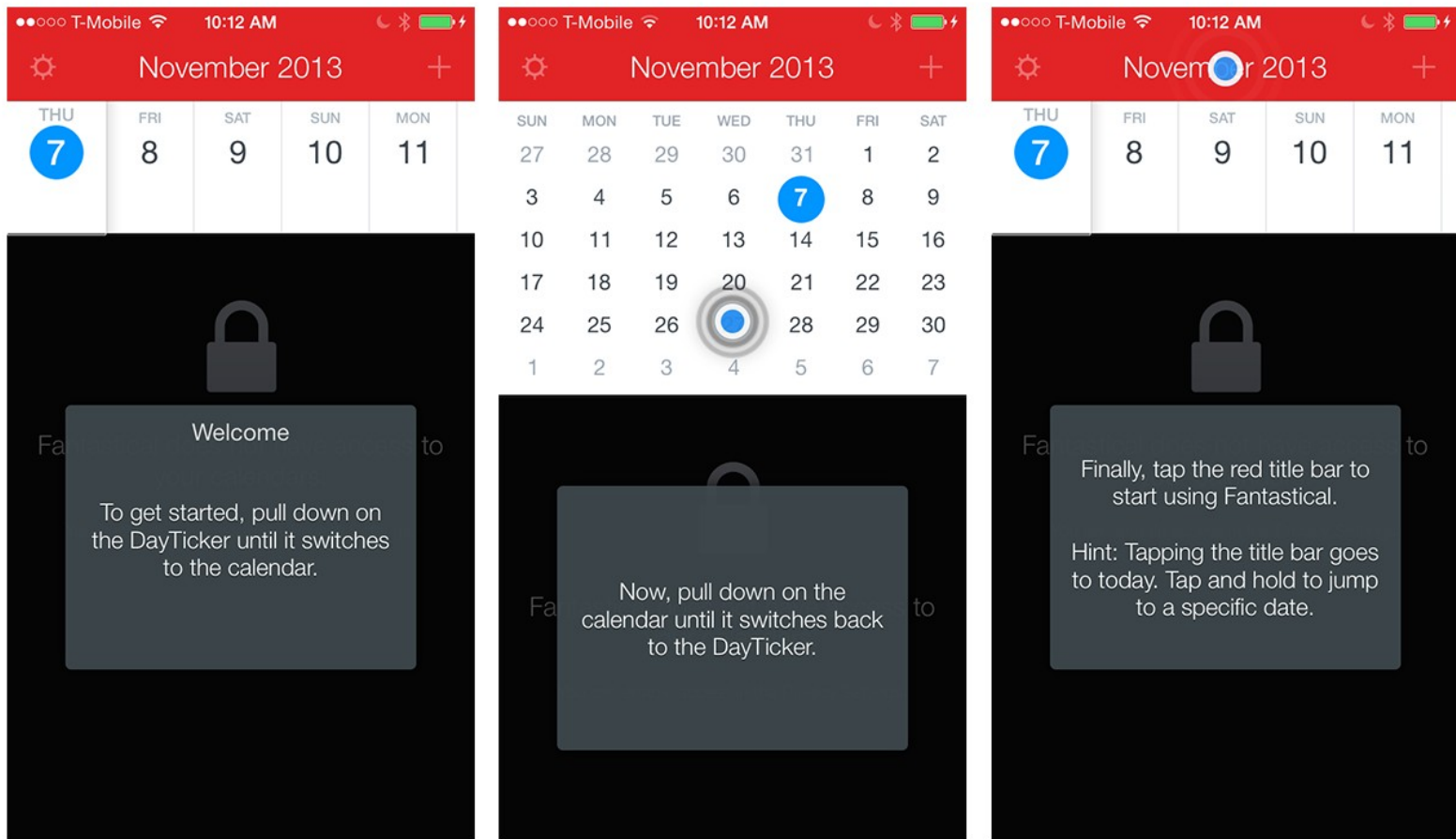
This tutorial describes actions to complete a procedure but doesn't let the user try them



This tutorial text encourages the user to learn by doing



messages invite the user to carry out actions and explain features



this tutorial invites the user to work through the gestures needed

Listen to your users

- “When you are a designer who has been working on a project for a year or two, it’s very easy to think things are intuitive or obvious that are actually totally incomprehensible”
- Your users are the only resource that counts when it comes to measuring the effectiveness of your tutorials
- Simple, properly conducted user testing will reveal any stumbling blocks
 - Observe your users to see where they get stuck and where they have problems
 - Listen to their comments as they interact with the app
 - Adapt your onboarding process based on the results

Other rules

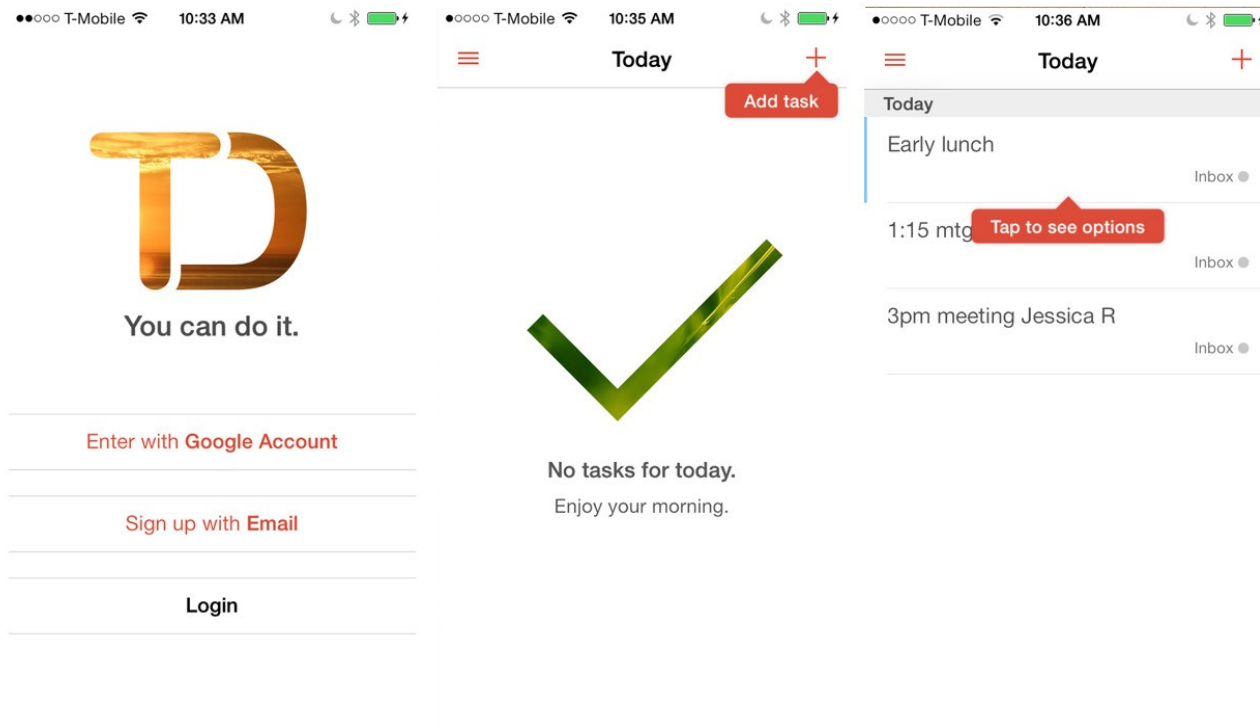
- To increase the usability and effectiveness of tutorials, designers should also:
 - Avoid waiting until the end to design the tutorial. Tutorials should be integrated into the overall design process from the very beginning
 - Make tutorials skippable
 - Make anything conveyed in the tutorial accessible at all times

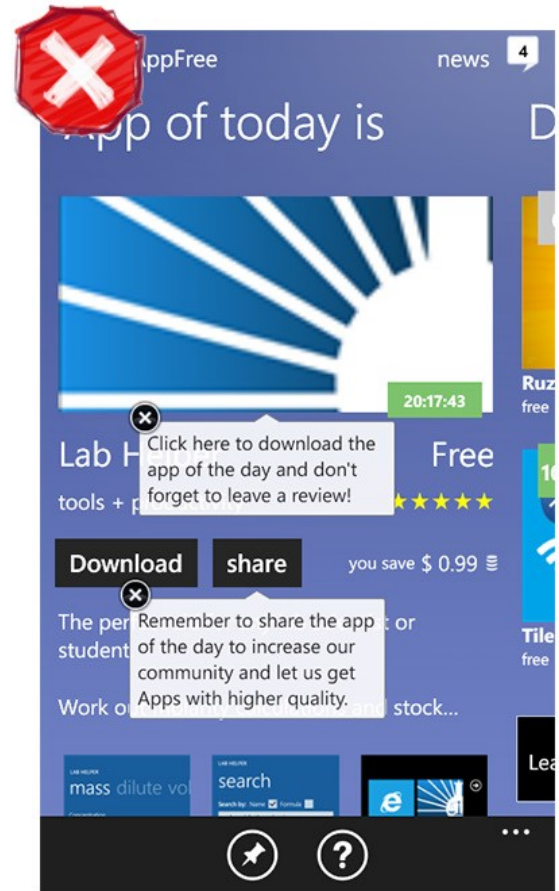
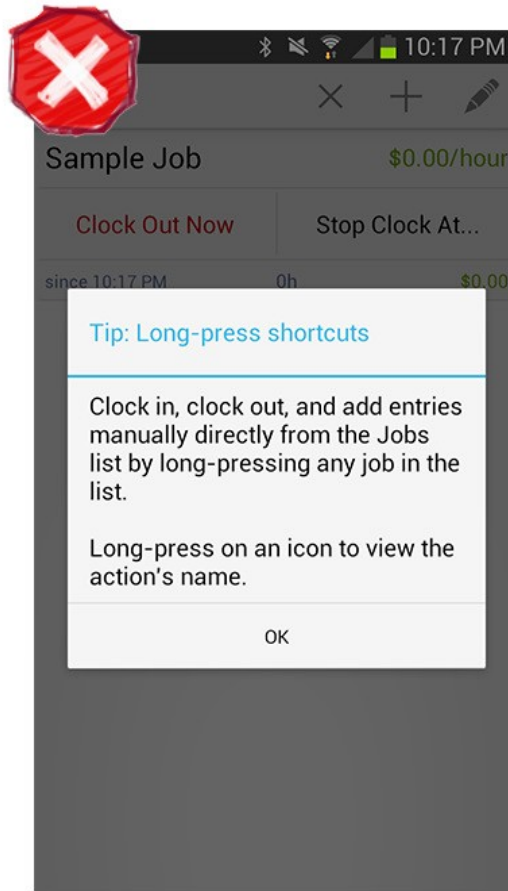
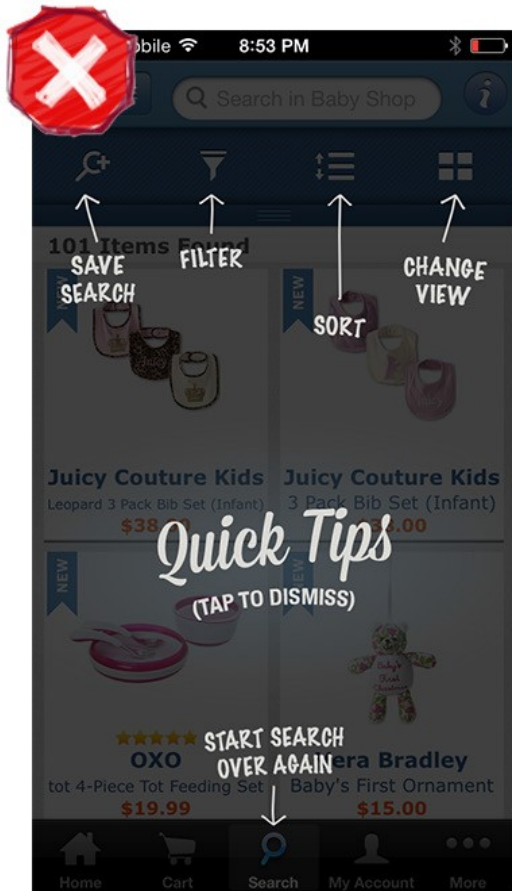
Invitation patterns

- Even if your app does not require a tutorial for onboarding, there are likely opportunities throughout the app to invite users to engage with a specific feature
- Invitations are also helpful to introduce new features within a specific flow, as opposed to just showing a dialog on launch with a list of new features
- Typical invitation patterns: ***tips***, ***persistent invitations***, ***discoverable invitations***

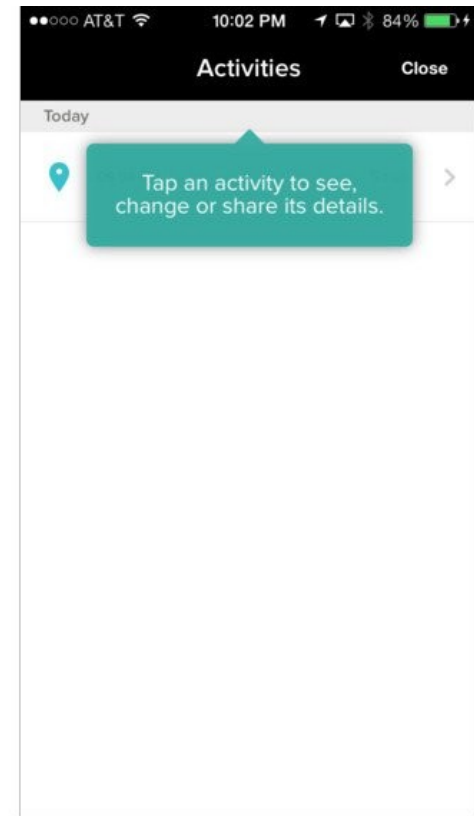
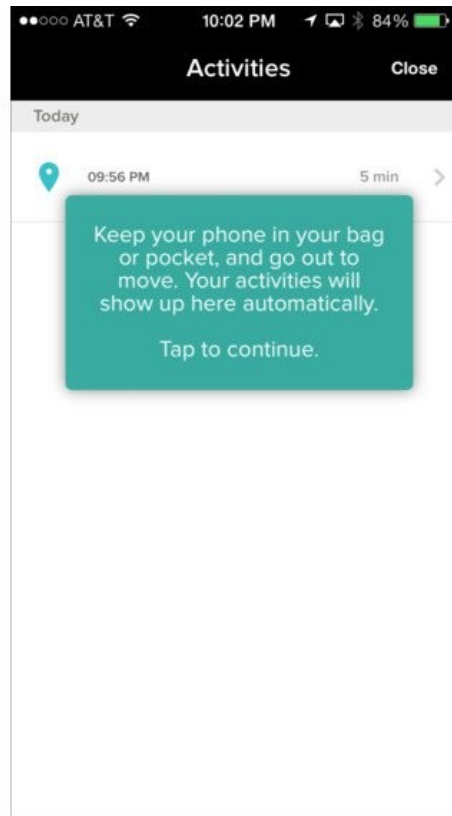
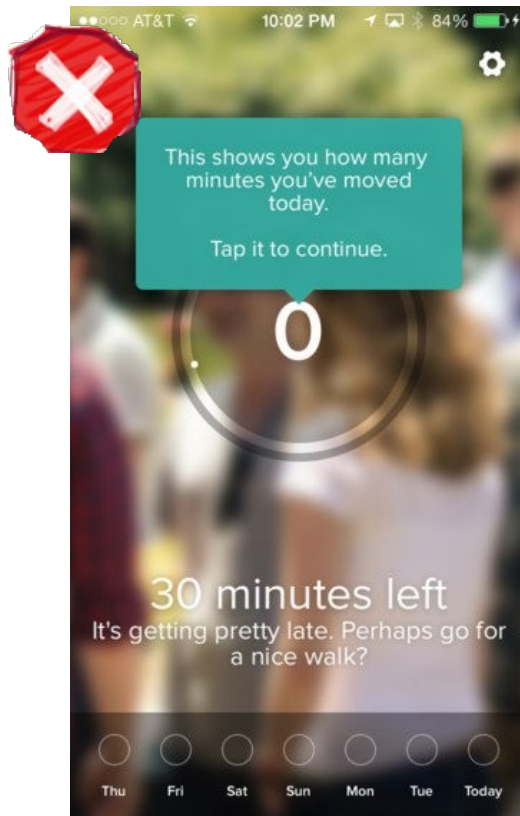
Tips

- Tips are short messages placed in proximity to the action or item they apply to
- Tips should be removed once interaction begins





Avoid tips in the form of transparencies and dialogs, or multiple tips per screen



Avoid chain of tips, especially when they aren't really necessary for first-time users

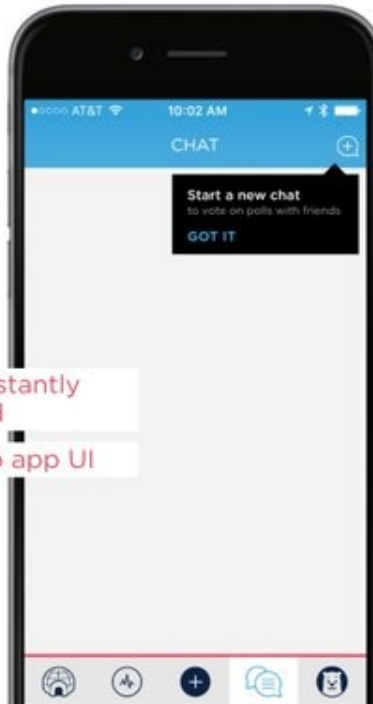
OVERLAY



almost instantly
dismissed

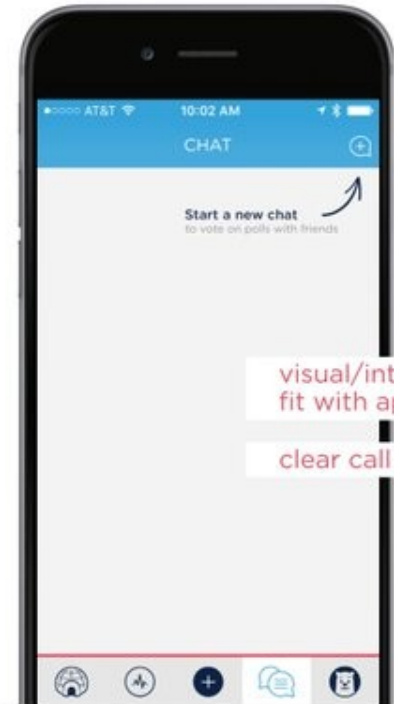
foreign to app UI

TOOLTIP



VS

INTEGRATED



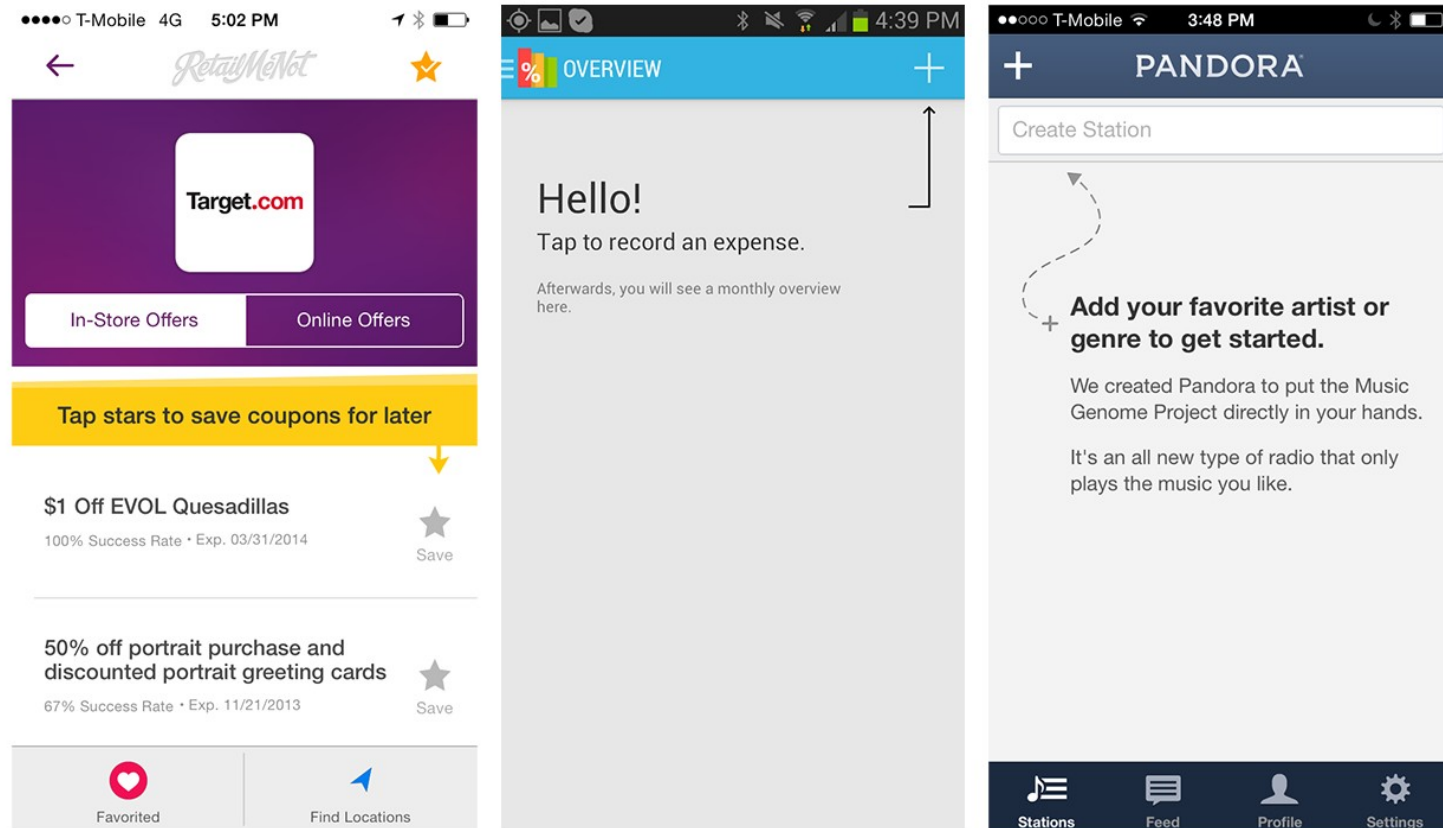
visual/interaction
fit with app UI

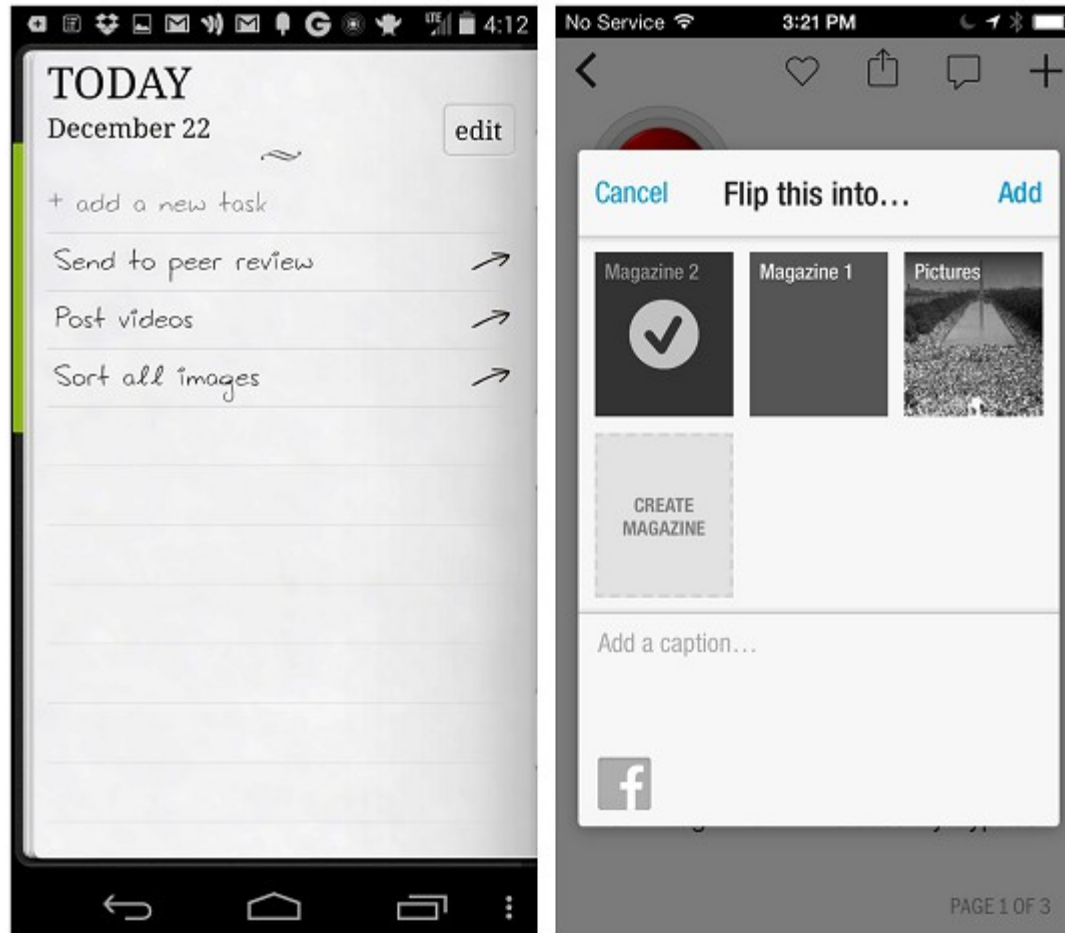
clear call to action

The less help & tips look like your app's UI, the more quickly they get dismissed/ignored

Persistent invitations

- Persistent invitations are short messages that are either always visible, or remain visible until the user takes the specified action

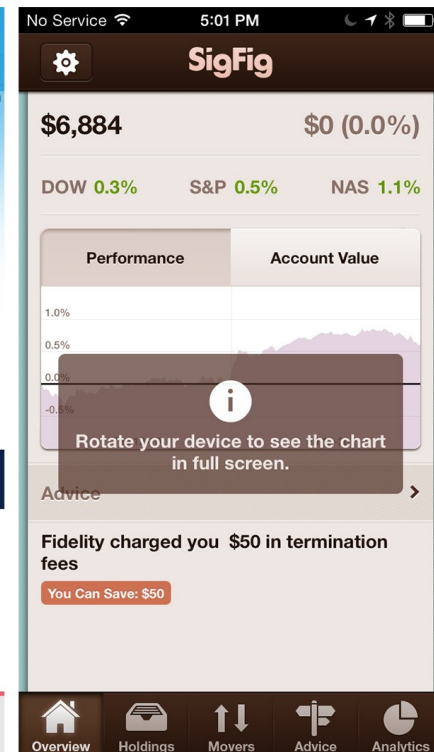
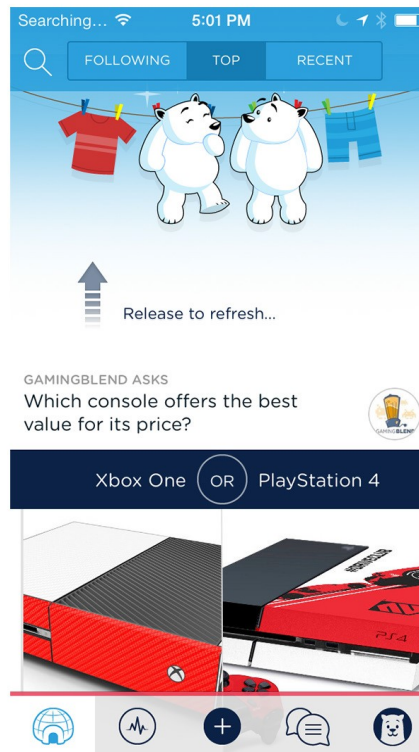
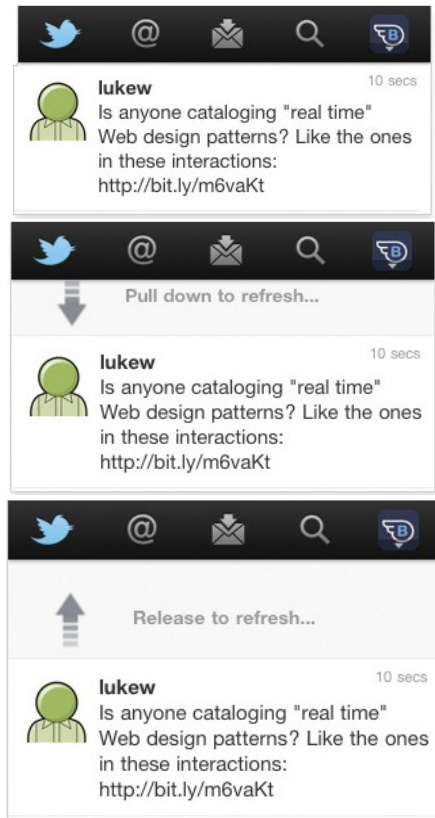


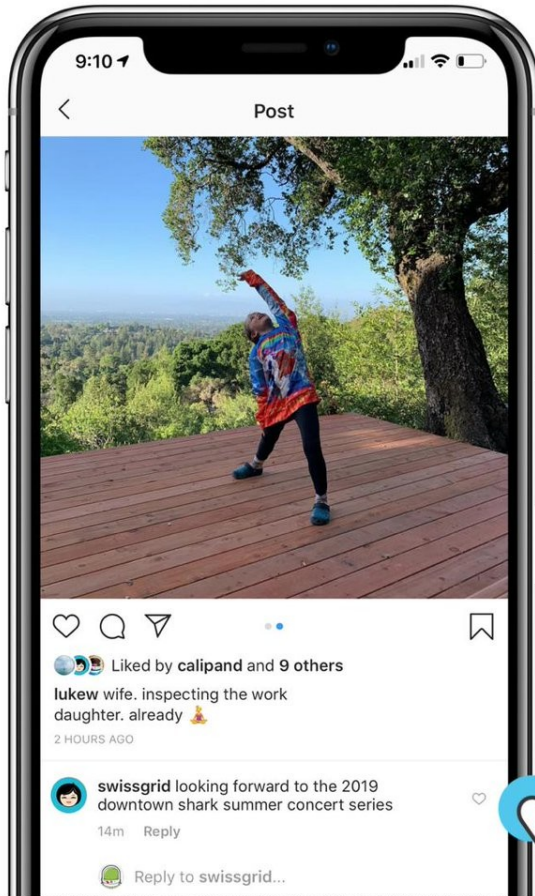


In some cases, persistent invitations remain always visible

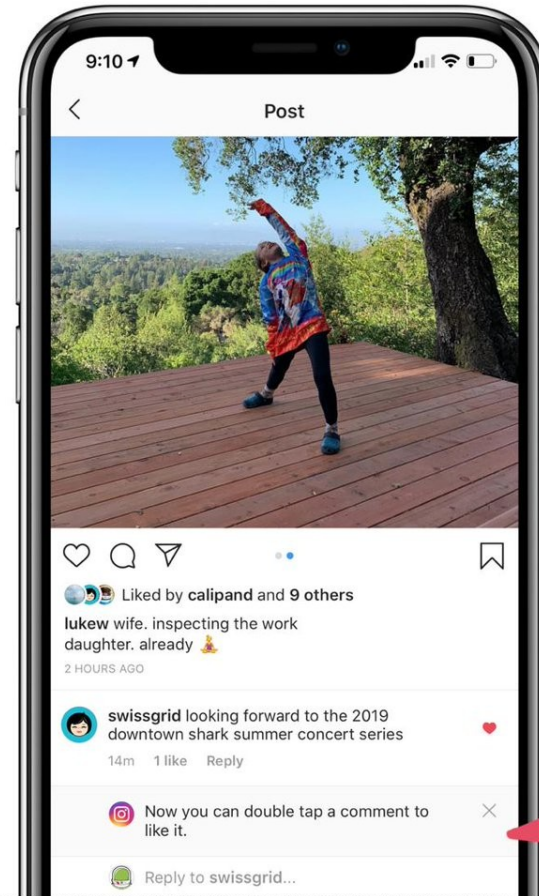
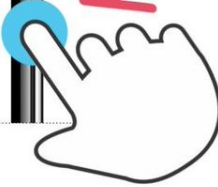
Discoverable invitations

- Discoverable invitations are meant to be discovered when the user performs a common gesture, like tapping, pulling, or swiping





tap icon to like a
comment



get inline tip about
(hidden) gesture
shortcut